

YOUTH & BIODIVERSITY

Biodiversity in the Field

One-line value proposition:

A youth field-learning programme that turns direct observation of biodiversity into scientific learning, curiosity and responsibility toward nature.

1. Project Title

Youth & Biodiversity — Biodiversity in the Field

2. Context / Problem

Biodiversity can remain abstract when environmental learning is separated from the species, habitats and ecological relationships it describes.

Hiking with Knowledge (HWK) uses Mongolia's natural landscapes as field-based learning environments. Existing HWK activities introduce participants to birds, wildlife, insects, plants, forests, wetlands and other biodiversity themes through direct observation and expert-supported learning.

This creates a practical foundation for a focused youth programme that connects biodiversity education with field science, observation and conservation awareness.

3. Project Objective

To strengthen young people's biodiversity knowledge, scientific curiosity and responsibility toward nature through structured, expert-supported field learning.

4. Target Group

- Young people and students
- Schools and youth groups
- Educators
- Community participants interested in biodiversity learning

Participant numbers and age range: [TO CONFIRM]

5. Proposed Activities

1. **Biodiversity field-learning sessions** focused on birds, insects, plants, wildlife and their habitats.
2. **Expert-supported observation and identification**, using relevant field guides, binoculars and other practical learning tools.
3. **Species and habitat observation exercises** that help participants connect individual species with broader ecosystem relationships.
4. **Macro photography and visual biodiversity learning**, using close observation to explore insects and other small organisms.
5. **Youth biodiversity documentation and storytelling**, turning observations and photographs into learning and conservation communication.
6. **Citizen-science-compatible observation or monitoring activities**, where appropriate methodology and technical support are provided by research or specialist partners.

6. Expected Outputs

- A structured youth biodiversity field-learning programme.
- Biodiversity learning modules covering selected species and ecosystem themes.
- Expert-supported field sessions.
- Youth-generated observations, photographs and learning stories.
- Practical learning materials and field activities.
- Opportunities for joint learning or monitoring with technical partners.

7. Expected Outcomes

The programme is intended to:

- improve practical understanding of biodiversity and ecological relationships;
- strengthen participants' ability to observe and identify species and habitats;
- increase scientific curiosity through direct field experience;
- strengthen awareness of why species and habitats need protection;
- create stronger links between young people, researchers, educators and conservation practitioners.

8. Expected Impact

Over time, the programme aims to contribute to a generation of young people who understand biodiversity not only as an academic concept, but as a living system they can observe, value and help protect.

No quantitative biodiversity or beneficiary impact target is proposed at concept stage.

9. HWK Approach

The programme applies the HWK model:

Hike → Learn → Experience → Care → Protect

Hike — enter natural environments and encounter biodiversity directly.

Learn — receive accessible scientific knowledge from relevant experts and educators.

Experience — observe species, habitats and ecological relationships in the field.

Care — build personal connection, curiosity and responsibility toward nature.

Protect — translate learning into conservation awareness and responsible behaviour.

10. Partnership Opportunity

HWK welcomes partners that can contribute through:

- programme funding or sponsorship;
- biodiversity and scientific expertise;
- expert training and educational support;
- research collaboration;
- citizen-science methodology;
- field equipment and learning resources;
- youth and institutional partnerships;
- joint field programmes and knowledge exchange.

The intention is to **co-create** the programme with partners rather than offer a fixed tourism product.

11. Funding Need

Funding amount: [TO CONFIRM]

Potential funding/resource categories include:

- programme coordination;
- expert facilitation;
- field transport and logistics;
- biodiversity observation equipment;
- educational and field-learning materials;
- documentation and communication;
- partner-supported research or monitoring activities.

A detailed budget will be developed once programme scope, location, duration and partner roles are confirmed.

12. Scalability / Replication Potential

HWK already works across several biodiversity themes, allowing the programme to be structured in modules such as:

Birds • Insects & Pollinators • Forest Plants • Wildlife • Wetland Biodiversity

This makes it possible to adapt the same learning model to different ecosystems, youth groups and institutional partners while retaining the same field-based educational approach.

Specific replication locations are **[TO CONFIRM]**.

13. Why HWK

HWK is relevant to this concept because it already combines:

- outdoor experience with environmental education;
- biodiversity and wildlife field activities;
- learning with researchers and other subject specialists;
- practical observation-based learning;
- youth and community engagement.

HWK therefore provides an existing field-learning platform on which a more structured youth biodiversity programme can be co-developed.

14. Suggested Partner Types

- Biodiversity and conservation organizations
- Environmental NGOs
- Universities and research institutions
- Youth and education organizations
- Schools and environmental education programmes
- Foundations and grant-makers
- Citizen-science initiatives
- Corporate / ESG partners supporting biodiversity or youth education

Partnership Ask

Partner with Hiking with Knowledge to co-create a youth biodiversity programme that turns Mongolia's landscapes into living classrooms for science, connection and conservation.